- **Bones**
  The fusion of bones increases during babyhood. Calcification begins in the early part of the first year but is not completed until puberty. The soft spot on the skull (tontanelle) will be closed by the end of two years.

DO YOU KNOW?

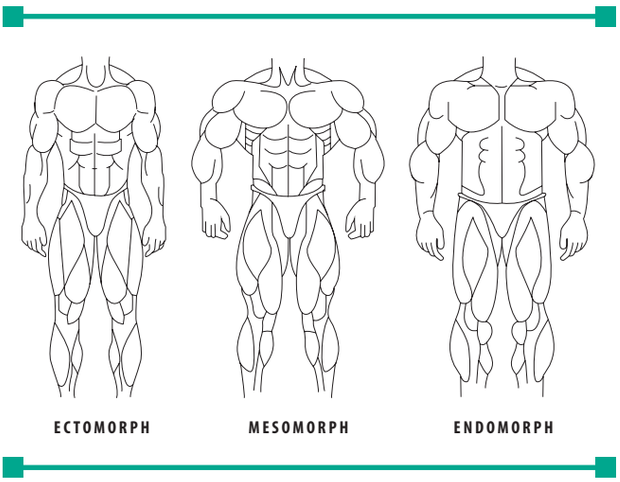
There are 270 bones at birth, but adult humans have only 206 bones.

- **Muscles and Fat**
  Muscle fibers are present at birth but in very under developed forms. They grow slowly during babyhood and are weak. The fat tissue develops rapidly during babyhood due partly to the high fat content of milk.

- **Body Builds**
  Babies begin to form characteristic body builds from during their second year of life. The three most common forms of body build are ectomorphic, which tends to be long and slender, endomorphic, which tends to be round and fat, and mesomorphic which tends to be heavy, hard and rectangular.

- **Teeth**
  By the end of one year the baby has four to six temporary teeth and sixteen by the age of two. The teeth present in the front will emerge first and the molars which are situated at the back appears last.

- **Nervous System**
  The brain weight is one-eighth of the baby's total weight at birth. During the first 2 years, brain weight is gained



▲ Fig. 5 Types of Body build

and this leads to the baby's top heavy appearance. The cerebellum and the cerebrum triple its weight in one year. Immature cells, present at birth, continue to develop after birth but relatively few new cells are formed.

DO YOU KNOW?

By the end of 2nd year a baby will have more than 100 trillion synapses. Name the synapses present in the baby?

By three months, the eye muscles are well developed and babies can see things clearly. They can also see colours. Hearing develops rapidly during this stage. Smell and taste are improved during babyhood. Babies are highly responsive to all skin stimuli because all sense organs relating to touch, pressure, pain, and temperature are present in well-developed forms.

DO YOU KNOW?

At birth babies can taste sweet, bitter and sour, but cannot taste salt until they are 4 months old.

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